



Make In India: Why There Is Struggle

Based on personal experience, the author explains why Make In India initiative is yet to make a mark in the electronics industry



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Having been in India all through my career and a part of the Indian government-owned telecommunications technology development centre, Centre for Development of Telematics, or C-DOT—which changed the profile of the Indian telecom industry—I was hopeful of Make in India succeeding at least in the electronics industry, because the auto industry in India demonstrated it can be done.

Recently, I was on a work trip to Shanghai and Shenzhen in China to develop/source 17.8cm (7-inch) tablets—it is cheaper to import tablets than making these in India, even after paying duties.

I met three vendors—one each for plastics, electronics and batteries. My experience was an eye-opener! Some of my observations are given below.

The plastics vendor's infrastructure is as good as I have seen in India, but why are we not able to get this done in India? What I noticed was the attitude of the vendor. He was very clear in terms of business, and never bothered about volume. His conditions were clear, too. He told me that he will do the tooling and supply the plastics. And if I wanted him to do only one of these, then he was not interested.

Second, he gave me the pricing based on volume. In India, this is never done. Most